

2. Power vs. responsibility, rights vs. obligations

The contradiction appears especially in the differentiation of power and responsibility as well as in the emphasis on rights at the expense of duties. This phenomenon has been shown to be typical of the neoliberal era, but it also appears in contexts other than environmental issues.

The problem arises if the decision-making does not give proper weight to the environment and community meanings. Companies do not always carry responsibility voluntarily, as business logic is primarily based on the growth of financial returns.

Several studies show the growth of corporate power and the weak possibilities of citizens to act as a counterforce in environmental issues. The imbalance of power relations can be seen in conflicts concerning the cultural and natural environment, but the challenge is that critical citizen discussion may not emerge. At the same time, the communities' possibilities to define local cultural heritage are weakening. The contradiction with, for example, the Faro Convention is significant. Civil society is expected to participate, but in practice its action is not supported.

Moreover, in legal practice, municipalities' self-governance rights often override environmental responsibility. The state administration authorities' opportunities to monitor the implementation of environmental responsibility have been reduced. The safety net of the law is faulty. The possibilities for preserving the built heritage seem to narrow even further if the changes to Finland's Building Act proceed along the path outlined by political guidance. This study raises the question of how the rights established in Finland's constitution and the country's commitments to international conventions are fulfilled.

3. Marginalization and lack of resources

The continued marginalization of built heritage preservation and the lack of resources for it maintain the contradiction. In the prevailing consumer culture, the effort is often left without financial and regulatory resources.

Behavioral research shows that information is not enough to change attitudes defined by the growth economy, consumer culture and the persistent beliefs that support them. Economic reasons are presented as self-evident and unquestioned in the media as well. In consumer culture, over the decades, the new has been seen as better than the old. Old buildings are frequently labeled as worthless or not meeting current requirements.

The study raises the question of whether the situation and core problems of building preservation have been defined analytically enough in recent years. Strategies always aim for better outcomes, but a shared understanding is the beginning of everything. For example, for built heritage professionals, the connections between sustainable development and protection appear self-